CORE ITEM UPDATE · INDIA

Core Item Update: Sneakers 2026–28

The Indian sneaker is growing up.

Forecut Editorial · 11 October 2026



Overview

The Indian sneaker is growing up. Handcrafted leather and kantha-embroidered sneakers are emerging, wider lasts address Indian foot shapes, and sneakers have become acceptable for sangeet and mehendi.

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INVEST	TEST	MAINTAIN	REDUCE

Invest: rising now. Test: emerging. Maintain: at its peak. Reduce: fading.

The details

Each detail with its status for Festive 26, its trend curve and what it does next.



INVEST RISING

Retro gum-sole sneakers

Vintage trainers with suede overlays and gum soles. Growth is building. Commit to it in your next range.



Festive 26 Rising	Summer 27 Peaking	Festive 27 Peaking
Summer 28 Peaking	Festive 28 Fading	



INVEST RISING

Sneakers for the groom

Embellished or clean sneakers for sangeet and mehendi. Growth is building. Commit to it in your next range.



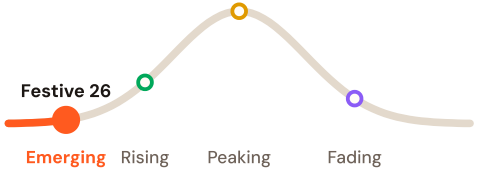
Festive 26 Rising	Summer 27 Peaking	Festive 27 Peaking
Summer 28 Peaking	Festive 28 Fading	



TEST EMERGING

Handcrafted leather sneakers

Full-grain leather sneakers made in India. Early signal. Trial in small drops and premium lines.



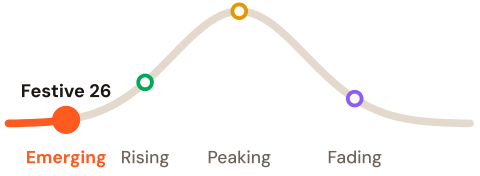
Festive 26 Emerging	Summer 27 Rising	Festive 27 Rising
Summer 28 Peaking	Festive 28 Peaking	



TEST EMERGING

Kantha-embroidered sneakers

Suede sneakers with kantha embroidery. Early signal. Trial in small drops and premium lines.



Festive 26 Emerging	Summer 27 Rising	Festive 27 Rising
Summer 28 Peaking	Festive 28 Peaking	

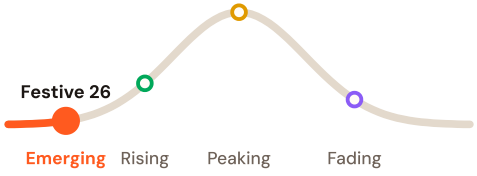


TEST

EMERGING

Wide lasts for Indian feet

Broader lasts shaped for Indian foot widths. Early signal. Trial in small drops and premium lines.



Festive 26 Emerging	Summer 27 Rising	Festive 27 Rising
Summer 28 Peaking	Festive 28 Peaking	

How to update your sneakers range

- Test handcrafted leather and embroidered sneakers in small runs.
- Offer a wider-fit last.
- Market clean and embellished sneakers for the groom's pre-wedding functions.

What to check in sneakers development

- **Last and fit:** specify toe shape and width; many customers need wider fits.
- **Sole:** slimmer, low-profile soles are rising; chunky soles are easing.
- **Materials:** suede, leather and mesh for different climates.
- **Comfort tech:** cushioning and breathable linings for hot weather.

Fabric guide

Choose fabric by occasion, climate and price point. The same design often needs two fabric options: a premium version and a value or summer version.

- Suede and leather for retro styles
- Mesh and knit uppers for heat
- Recycled materials for sustainable lines
- Canvas for value ranges

The global view

Indian sneakers sell well beyond India, to South Asian communities in the UK, North America, the Gulf, Southeast Asia and Australia, and increasingly to customers discovering Indian craft. For international customers, provide clear size conversions, care guidance and styling ideas for local events.

Common questions

Are sneakers fading? The everyday chunky sneaker is easing, while slim retro and running styles keep rising. Sneakers worn with ethnic wear remain strong with younger customers.

Which sneakers suit hot climates? Mesh and knit uppers with breathable linings and light soles.

See every sneakers detail with design notes and downloadable cards in the India Forecast 2026–28.

Statuses are Forecut's forecast for India: Festive 26 (Oct 2026 – Feb 2027), Summer 27 (Mar – Jul 2027), Festive 27 (Aug – Dec 2027), and long-range outlooks for Summer 28 (Mar – Jul 2028) and Festive 28 (Aug – Dec 2028). Sources: India trends summarise public coverage of Lakmé Fashion Week x FDCI 2026 (Harper's Bazaar India, Free Press Journal), Aza Fashions festive and ethnic trend guides, Lashkaraa colour and silhouette trends 2026, Pearl Academy Gen Z trend reports, Gully Labs, Global Indian (Prada SS26 Kolhapuri-inspired sandals) and Outlook Business (Gen Z and e-retail).